1. He/she acts as the *ex-officio* Chairman of Rajya Sabha. In this capacity, his/her powers and functions are similar to those of the Speaker of Lok Sabha. In this respect, he/she resembles the American vice-president, who also acts as the Chairman of the Senate—the Upper House of the American legislature.

2. He/she acts as President when a vacancy occurs in the office of the President due to his/her resignation, impeachment, death or otherwise.[6] He/she can act as President only for a maximum period of six months within which a new President has to be elected. Further, when the sitting President is unable to discharge his/her functions due to absence, illness or any other cause, the Vice-President discharges his/her functions until the President resumes his/her office.[7]

While acting as President or discharging the functions of President, the Vice-President does not perform the duties of the office of the chairman of Rajya Sabha. During this period, those duties are performed by the Deputy Chairman of Rajya Sabha.

The Constitution has not fixed any emoluments for the Vice-President in that capacity. He/she draws his/her regular salary in his/her capacity as the *ex-officio* Chairman of the Rajya Sabha. In 2018, the Parliament increased the salary of the Chairman of the Rajya Sabha from ₹1.25 lakh to ₹4 lakh per month[8]. Earlier in 2008, the pension of the retired Vice-President was increased from ₹20,000 per month to 50% of his/her salary per month[9]. In addition, he/she is entitled to daily allowance, free furnished residence, medical, travel and other facilities.

During any period when the Vice-President acts as President or discharges the functions of the President, he/she is not entitled to the salary or allowance payable to the Chairman of Rajya Sabha, but the salary and allowance of the President.

INDIAN AND AMERICAN VICEPRESIDENTS COMPARED

Though the office of the Indian Vice- President is modelled on the lines of the American Vice-President, there is a difference. The American Vice-President succeeds to the presidency when it falls vacant, and remains President for the unexpired term of his/her predecessor. The Indian Vice-President, on the other hand, does not assume the office of the President when it falls vacant for the unexpired term. He/she merely serves as an acting President until the new President assumes charge.

It is evident that the Constitution has not assigned any significant function to the Vice-President in that capacity. Hence, some scholars call him/her 'His Superfluous Highness'. This office was created with a view to maintain the political continuity of the Indian State.

Table 19.2 Articles Related to Vice-President at a Glance

Article No.	Subject-matter
63.	The Vice-President of India
64.	The Vice-President to be ex-officio Chairman of the Council of States